

Gap and Issue Triage Register

Consolidated, ranked triage of gaps, blockers, and issues — SBTDWS transformation

Prepared by SBTDWS | 2026-06-19 | Pre-decisional planning document

Consolidated, ranked triage of every gap, blocker, and issue identified across the SBTDWS transformation analysis (FIC analysis, institutional barriers review, CTC architecture model, 9 directed tasks mapping, command decisions log, and the J3 working group back-brief of 2026-06-10). Built to feed the J3/Commander engagement: what can be fixed at SBTDWS level, what cannot be resolved below Higher HQ / PG HQ, and what needs to change before the OPOrd is released to units.

How to read this register. Items are triaged by who can act and how urgent, not by which source document they came from. Tier 0 is the OPOrd timing risk — act before the OPOrd is issued, not after. Tiers 1–4 mirror escalation level.

Tier 0 — Paper 2 / OPOrd Window (Act Before OPOrd Release)

This is the time-boxed opportunity available now. Two live discrepancies exist between the written planning guidance and the verbal direction given at the most recent J3 working group session (2026-06-10). If the OPOrd is cut from the written guidance as currently worded, it will lock in language that direction has already informally moved away from.

#	Issue	Written guidance	Verbal J3 direction (2026-06-10)	Recommendation
1	Domain scope	Train/validate units to deliver synchronised effect across all six domains (air, sea, land, cyber, electromagnetic, space)	Prioritise land and partial air now; scope maritime/space/cyber/EMS "later if required"	Amend task language to a phased domain commitment before OPOrd — otherwise units are tasked against a six-domain standard already de-scoped verbally
2	Naming	Names the 2030 end-state the "All Domain Warfare Centre" (ADWC)	Referred to as "Multi Domain Warfare Centre" (MDWC) — no official decision made	Do not let the OPOrd cement a name in dispute. Either confirm formally pending decision, or flag as "under review"
3	Main effort / supporting effort weighting	Task ordering implies training/course delivery is foundational alongside validation and experimentation, no explicit main/supporting split	Reprioritised: main effort = collective training/validation/mission rehearsal + tactical experimentation; supporting effort = courses and training (demoted)	OPOrd should explicitly carry this main/supporting split so resourcing decisions don't default to the old course-centric framing

4	Capability development handoff timing	Directs handoff of the existing capability development cell to the new Innovation Command — no date specified	Transition plan still pending, required within the next year	Attach a trigger date or condition to the OPORD instruction, not an open-ended instruction
5	Training authority lane split undocumented	Implies SBTDWS supports the wider exercise programme	The document that defines this lane split is overdue against its original target	Either reference the lane-split agreement as a named deliverable with a hard date in the OPORD, or escalate now so it exists before units plan against it
6	Validation authority unstated	Directs SBTDWS to exercise validation responsibility for two Study and Evaluation Groups	No authority defined — certify/fail/recommend-remediation vs advisory-only is still pending	The single biggest credibility risk in the whole transformation. OPORD should not assume validation authority exists — flag as a pre-condition

Why this is Tier 0: these are not new decisions — they are existing pending decisions with a hard external deadline attached: the OPORD drafting window. Once the OPORD is cut, the cost of correcting these rises sharply.

Tier 1 — Cannot Resolve at SBTDWS Level: Escalate to J3/Commander Now

These require Higher HQ or PG HQ action. SBTDWS has done what it can — surfacing them is the purpose of the brief.

Rank	Issue	Owner	Status	Why it's top of the list
1	Irregular Warfare / Unconventional Warfare boundary clarification	Higher HQ	Pending, blocks multiple downstream items	Cannot write validation standards, training curriculum, or define the individual/collective training split without it. Named repeatedly as the highest-leverage unresolved item above Commandant level
2	Validation authority	PG HQ	Pending	Without this, validation is advisory only and the entire Observer-Trainer cadre investment produces reports commanders can ignore
3	Validation standards ownership	PG HQ	Pending	Curriculum design cannot be finalised without it; work risks being redone if standards arrive late or change
4	Staff support model (organic / allocated / liaison)	PG HQ	Pending, required before structural reorganisation	Gates the planned structural reorganisation and sizing of exercise control capability. Open since the transformation concept was first drafted
5	Single point of failure risk	Command awareness / resourcing decision	Not yet a formal decision, but flagged repeatedly	Validation responsibility for two Study and Evaluation Groups, the unconventional warfare raising mission, tactical experimentation leadership, and mission rehearsal facility development all currently sit on the same

				organisation without dedicated resource for any of them. Needs to be stated explicitly, not left implicit
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Tier 2 — Command Can Act Without External Authority

These don't need Higher HQ or PG HQ — they need command action, and two are already overdue.

Rank	Issue	Status	Note
1	Direct the engagement to formally agree the training/validation lane split with the wider exercise programme owner	Overdue	Lowest-effort, highest-leverage action available. A single tasking unlocks the formal relationship. Should be actioned regardless of brief timing
2	Commit to backing the first adverse assessment	Pending	Hardest decision on this list but the precondition for the Observer-Trainer cadre meaning anything. Should be communicated to cadre leadership before the structure that depends on it stands up
3	Endorse the three-wing structural design	Pending	Conceptual, no resource ask — should be the easiest decision available. Its absence is now the long pole holding up staff communication of the design

Tier 3 — Institutional / Cultural (Slow-Burn, No Single Decision Fixes It)

These barriers are documented separately and translated into command-safe language for use in formal briefs. They are not blocked by a single pending decision — they require sustained command tone-setting, and the 2030 timeline assumes they are fixed faster than institutional culture typically changes.

Barrier	Command-safe framing used in briefs	Risk if unaddressed
Inflated pass rates	"Strengthen assessment credibility"	Validation system remains theatre even if higher-level authority decisions are favourable
Lack of constructive feedback	"Improve visibility of training outcomes"	Observer-Trainer cadre repeats the pattern it is meant to replace
Weak instructor accountability	"Mature instructor standards"	Poor performers retained; standards erode under pressure
Mid-level management resistance	"Build institutional capacity"	Named as the primary political risk at the structural reorganisation inflection point
Contractor dependency	"Consolidate military ownership of core skills"	Unsustainable as a validation institution; military-ownership target at risk
Resource shortages	"Strengthen training system foundations"	Training continuity disrupted independent of any higher-level decision
Bureaucratic delays	"Improve training continuity"	Schedule risk compounds on top of decision delays

Hiding deficiencies	"Enhance readiness assurance"	Directly contradicts the "truth before excellence" principle the transformation is built on
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Timeline tension worth stating plainly: initial operating capability is targeted within a few years. These are cultural/institutional barriers, which historically take longer to fix than capability or infrastructure gaps. There is a real risk the transformation timeline does not allow enough time for cultural change to precede the capability build it depends on.

Tier 4 — Longer Horizon (Capability-Gating, Not Urgent for This Brief)

Worth listing for completeness so command can pre-empt them, but these don't need to be the headline of this particular brief.

Item	Owner	Required by
Mission rehearsal facility concept of use and capital commitment	PG HQ (capital) / Commandant (concept)	Capital planning must begin ahead of the next budget cycle
Capability development cell transition to Innovation Command	PG HQ / Commandant	Within the next year
Formal governance of tactical experimentation with the Warfare Development Centre	J3 / Commandant	Before experimentation activity scales up
All-domain training enablers (cyber, electromagnetic, space)	External enablers (signals, research, coalition)	Tied to full operating capability, not initial operating capability
Integration layer across courses, capability development, and exercises	No single owner currently assigned	Flagged as the defining structural gap; still unassigned

Cross-Reference: Structural Gaps vs Full Validation Centre Model

For completeness, the gap list from the full validation-centre model (what the organisation would need to function as the formation's validation institution) maps onto the above as follows — nothing new, but it confirms the same items surface from a different analytical angle.

Element	Status	Maps to
Exercise control capability	Gap	Staff support model, Tier 1 #4
Higher control element	Gap	Staff support model
Observer-Trainer cadre	Developing	Adverse assessment backing, validation authority, standards ownership
Full staff function integration	Gap	Staff support model
Scenario design cell	Partial	Tier 4, resourcing
Instrumentation	Gap	Mission rehearsal facility capital decision

Mission rehearsal facility integration	Gap	Mission rehearsal facility capital decision
Validation authority	Unconfirmed	Tier 1 #2

Suggested Brief Structure

1. **Open with Tier 0** — the OPORD timing window. This is the one part of the brief with a hard expiry: once the OPORD is cut, the six items above become much more expensive to fix.
 2. **Tier 1 as the "decisions we cannot make for you" section** — the four standing decisions, plus the single-point-of-failure risk stated explicitly.
 3. **Tier 2 as proof of momentum** — show the command-level actions are already in motion or about to be actioned, so the brief isn't purely a list of asks.
 4. **Tier 3 mentioned, not dwelt on** — the institutional barriers are already documented in command-safe language; reference rather than re-litigate.
 5. **Tier 4 flagged as "on the radar, not today's ask."**
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This register is a planning consolidation, not a directive. All figures and statuses reflect internal analysis as of the date above and should be verified against current command positions before use in formal correspondence.